

Intel India opens new design facility in Bengaluru

Expanding its R&D presence in India, chip maker Intel recently inaugurated a new design facility in Bengaluru. Built with an investment of approximately ₹ 11 billion, the new design house—called SRR4—is located at Intel's campus in Bengaluru. Covering 55741.84sqm of space, the design facility includes 9290.30sqm of lab infrastructure. Sources at Intel said that the new facility will house technologists who work on cutting-edge engineering across hardware and software.

DRDO chief announces fund for defence startups

Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) chief, Dr Satheesh Reddy has announced financial support to startups and other entities working in the research, development and production areas within the defence sector. According to a report in *Deccan Chronicle*, Dr Reddy has encouraged the setting up of defence incubation centres in India to help youngsters turn their ideas into workable products.

Hero Cycles partners with Yamaha and Mitsui for electric bicycles in India

Hero Cycles has inked a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Yamaha Motors and Mitsui of Japan to introduce

Hero electric bicycles powered by Yamaha's e-kits—the power source designed for electrically-assisted bicycles. The electric bicycles are set for testing, and Hero Cycles' network (and brand name) will be used to sell this new range called E-MTB. The collaboration is also set to explore business possibilities available for electric bicycles in India.

Kerala government partners with Olectra-BYD for electric buses

The government of Kerala has partnered with Olectra-BYD, a firm dealing with electric public transport systems, to run electric buses for public transport. The company's eBuzz K7 model of buses, which are already plying in Kullu-Manali-Rohtang Pass in Himachal Pradesh, will run in Kerala too, to carry pilgrims to Sabarimala temple. The company will supply around 10 electric buses to the state government. N. Naga Satyam, executive director, Olectra-BYD, said that the buses can run on all kinds of terrains.

Nokia, Oppo sign multi-year patent licence agreement

Finnish telecommunications major Nokia has inked a patent licence agreement with Chinese consumer electronics and mobile communications company Oppo. As a part of the agreement, Oppo will make payments to Nokia for a multi-year licence period. The terms of the agreement will remain confidential between both parties, the company said in a statement.

planned to invest around ₹ 140 billion in the next three years to locally produce camera modules, touchscreen panels, thin-film transistors, flexible printed circuits and fingerprint modules, exclusively for Xiaomi.

World's first one-cell EV powertrain system to be manufactured in India

IPEC Drive Systems (IDS), the newly-formed joint venture between IPEC

India and L7 Drive of Finland, was formally launched by Nina Vaskunlahti, ambassador of Finland to India, at Finnish Embassy in New Delhi.

IDS will customise, adapt and manufacture the pathbreaking L7 drive systems for the global electric vehicle (EV) manufacturing sector. L7 drive technology employs just one lithium-ion battery cell, or a pack of parallel connected cells, to drive an electric motor in an EV. This

eliminates the need for a battery management system and the problems associated with cell balancing.

The solution results in superior vehicle range, enhanced performance and increased reliability, while optimising overall costs. Cloud connectivity capabilities of these drive systems can transform EVs into connected vehicles—a critical requirement for the future.

Consistent fall in battery prices will drive growth in electric bus market

Technavio, a UK-based market research and analyst firm, has predicted that the electric bus market will register a CAGR of above 12 per cent by 2022, owing to the decrease in battery prices. According to analysts, advancements in lithium-ion batteries have not only reduced the overall weight of electric buses but also increased their life span, compared to conventional lead-acid and valve-regulated lead-acid battery-powered buses.

Consistent decrease in battery prices will drive the electric bus market growth during the forecast period, the report said.

AMTRON, Quantum partner for quantum dot solar cell manufacturing unit in Assam

Assam Electronics Development Corp. (AMTRON) has signed an agreement with Quantum Materials Corp. (QMC), a nano-material and quantum dot manufacturer, to set up a thin-film quantum dot solar cell manufacturing facility in Assam. The two entities will be working on the development, manufacturing and commercialisation of solar cells at the electronics manufacturing cluster in Guwahati Tech City.

As per the agreement, AMTRON will provide the required financial support, such as licence fee of US\$ 1 million, technology development funding, scheduled milestone payments and royalties on all quantum dot solar cells produced.

QMC will aid the manufacturing unit with the required equipment for production.